

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from an article about a doll hospital in Australia:

Welcome to Sydney's Famous Original Doll Hospital

The Doll Hospital has cared for dolls, teddy bears, wheeled toys and many other items for over 100 years. Business boomed during World War II, when there were very few new dolls being made or sold, but today, 80% of the business comes from adults who want to restore their childhood memories or pass on their childhood toys to their grandchildren or others.

"Doctors" who work at the family-run hospital specialize in repairing different things, such as antique and modern dolls, teddy bears and soft toys, prams, suitcases and handbags etc. "The interesting part of our job is that no two dolls are the same, so every day poses a new challenge for us," say the doctors. "There is nothing more satisfying than seeing the smile on a customer's face when they reunite with their beloved toy."

Aside from doll repairs, you can also wander for hours around the Doll Shop, which carries everything you could possibly dream of in a doll shop. There are dollhouses and hand-made dresses for dolls, with matching bonnets and pants. Prices for dolls start at around AUD\$20 (around HK\$140), for a regular doll, to thousands for a rare collector's doll.

So if you have a precious doll or bear stuffed in a cupboard, maybe injured, aged and a little neglected, it's time to take them to Sydney's Famous Original Doll Hospital, and ensure they will be passed on and loved for many years to come.

You and your group study Business Studies. Your group is discussing whether a doll hospital would be a good business idea in Hong Kong. You may want to talk about:

- why people want to repair their old toys
- whether a doll hospital business in Hong Kong would be successful
- how a doll hospital could be marketed
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. What toys did you play with?
2. Do you still keep your childhood toys?
3. What toys do young children like to play with nowadays?
4. Is it worth spending money repairing old toys?
5. Why do adults like to collect toys?
6. Can children live without toys?
7. Will electronic games replace traditional toys?
8. Do you think toys play an important role in a child's development?